



CYBER SECURITY
Engineering & Operations



15+

YEARS OF IT EXPERIENCE

9+ YEARS IN SECURITY

CONTACT



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farhan6667.github.io/portfolio



github.com/farhan6667

TECHNICAL SKILLS

DETECTION AND SIEM

Wazuh, OpenSearch, IBM QRadar, Elastic, Zabbix, Open EDR, custom rule development, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, File Integrity Monitoring, auditd, threat hunting, alert triage

FORENSICS AND INCIDENT RESPONSE

Oxygen Forensic Detective, Magnet AXIOM, Mobiledit Ultra Pro, mobile and Windows forensics, chain of custody, imaging, timeline reconstruction, ransomware containment

OFFENSIVE SECURITY AND MALWARE ANALYSIS

web application and API penetration testing, OWASP Top 10, access control and business logic testing, vulnerability assessment, static and dynamic malware analysis, reverse engineering, webshell and backdoor analysis, IOC extraction

INFRASTRUCTURE AND NETWORK

Linux and Windows hardening, SSH and privileged access, CIS benchmarking, FortiGate and Sophos, segmentation, Active Directory, AWS workload security

GOVERNANCE

ISO/IEC 27001, IS audit fundamentals, access governance, security policy and compliance

TECHNICAL HIGHLIGHTS



1,750+

Endpoints managed



400+

Domains secured



50+

Critical applications



124

Custom Wazuh rules



43

MITRE ATT&CK techniques



8

AI agents developed

SYED FARHAN AHMED

HEAD OF CYBER SECURITY

INCIDENT RESPONSE

DIGITAL FORENSICS

DETECTION ENGINEERING

THREAT HUNTING

PENETRATION TESTING

SECURITY ARCHITECTURE



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Head of Cyber Security with 15 years in IT and the last nine in security. Responsible for security operations across a Head Office environment of 1,750+ endpoints, including Madani Channel, within a wider organisation of approximately 28,000 employees across Pakistan. Built and now lead the cybersecurity function while remaining hands-on across incident response, detection engineering, threat hunting, digital forensics, penetration testing and security architecture. CHFI, CISA, CEH, eJPT and PNPT certified.



PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

F Tech Solutions Dawat-e-Islami

February 2015 to Present

Karachi · In-house IT and security function serving Madani Channel and other group entities

Head of Cyber Security

February 2023 to Present

Lead the cybersecurity function and set its technical direction while remaining hands-on across investigations, incident response and security engineering.

- Led response to a compromise affecting 11 production hosting servers, containing and remediating every host, investigating compromised SSH keys, backdoor accounts, authorised key files and cron-job persistence, and completing root-cause analysis.
- Ran the resulting hardening programme, moving the SOC from reactive to proactive detection through auditd/whodata process attribution, File Integrity Monitoring, fleet-wide credential rotation and application-key exposure assessment.
- Built detection engineering from zero to 124 custom Wazuh rules covering 43 MITRE ATT&CK techniques, with gap analysis across initial access, execution, persistence and privilege escalation.
- Designed and built eight AI agents supporting SIEM rule development, File Integrity Monitoring, continuous security monitoring, assessment tracking and vulnerability dashboards, with workflows and security requirements defined under my direction and review.
- Directed security testing across 400+ domains and a scheduled programme covering 50+ core applications, including OWASP Top 10, API security, access control, business logic and misconfiguration, with retesting to confirm remediation.
- Act as the organisation's forensic examiner using licensed Oxygen Forensic Detective and Magnet AXIOM, leading internal investigations including a PKR 80 million corruption case.
- Perform hands-on malware and webshell analysis and reverse engineering of untrusted third-party binaries to identify embedded malware and backdoors before production, while leading the cybersecurity department across offensive, defensive, governance, penetration testing, DevSecOps and SOC functions.

IT Security Analyst

October 2017 to February 2023

- Built the organisation's security monitoring capability across its operating divisions and established the forensic practice: evidence handling procedures, tooling and reporting standards.
- Deployed endpoint protection, encryption and firewall controls across the estate, and designed network infrastructure to meet connectivity and reliability requirements.

Helpdesk Manager

October 2016 to October 2017

- Managed the IT help desk function and day-to-day service delivery.



EARLIER EXPERIENCE

F Tech Solutions (Dawat-e-Islami), Karachi

IT Support Officer, Help Desk February 2015 to October 2016

- Supported international video and audio conferencing for broadcast operations, delivered endpoint support across Windows, macOS and Android, and managed remote patching and asset tracking through SysAid.

Finest Computer Institute (Pvt.) Ltd., Karachi

IT Instructor, part-time August 2011 to November 2014

- Taught CompTIA A+ and Network+ certification courses over three years.

SINA Sadiq International News Agency (Pvt.) Ltd., Karachi

IT Support and Network Solutions November 2011 to April 2013

- Log analysis and fault identification, wired and wireless network deployment, endpoint and laptop anti-theft security.

Sunny Co International (Pvt.) Ltd., Karachi

System Security and Network Support

September 2011 to March 2012

- Network deployment and maintenance, endpoint security and logging.



TRAINING & COURSE COMPLETIONS

Black Hat	Advanced APT Threat Hunting and Incident Response · Black Hat USA · 2023 · ID 79289732 ↗
TIC CIU	Certified WAN Associate, scored 81 per cent · Technology Incubation Center CIU · 2014 · ID TCCWA3948220238
HP LIFE	e-Learning, IT for Business Success · HP · 2014 · ID 1613875-39098
CTTC	MCITP Enterprise Server 2008 (2014), Network Plus (2012), A+ Certification (2012) · CTTC (Pvt) Ltd
Silicon	Network+ Certification, Student ID 00659 · Silicon Technologies · 2011
Netacad	CCNA Discovery, Networking for Home and Small Businesses · Cisco Networking Academy · 2008
MS Office	MS Office Diploma, graded A-One · Finest Computer Institute · 2004
MCSE	PC and Internet Security · Microsoft Certificate of Excellence



EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (Hons), Telecommunication

Newports Institute of Communications and Economics, Karachi. Recognised by the University of Karachi as equivalent to B.Sc, 2017.

Diploma of Associate Engineering (D.A.E.), Computer Information Technology

Sindh Board of Technical Education, Karachi.

Hafiz-e-Quran

Madrassa-tul-Madina, Landhi, Karachi. Complete memorisation of the Quran, certified after examination, 2005. Registration 153, Certificate 4676.



CERTIFICATIONS

KEY CERTIFICATIONS

CHFI	Computer Hacking Forensic Investigator 2026 EC-Council · ECC9386405217 ↗ · as Syed Farhan Ahmed
CISM	Certified Information Security Manager 2021 ISACA · Verify ↗
CISA	Certified Information Systems Auditor 2016 ISACA · 16133028 ↗ · as Farhan Ahmed
CEH	Certified Ethical Hacker 2023 EC-Council · ECC9851206734 ↗ · as Farhan Ahmed
eJPT v2	Junior Penetration Tester 2026 INE Security · 173841033 ↗
ICCA	INE Certified Cloud Associate 2025 INE Security · 163114102 ↗
PNPT	Practical Network Penetration Tester 2025 TCM Security · 113940089 ↗

ADDITIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

CAPC	Cybersecurity Awareness Professional 2024 CertiProf · d1dd82be ↗
CSA	Certified SOC Analyst 2022 EC-Council · ECC0475381296 ↗ · as Farhan Ahmed
RWPC	Remote Work Professional 2022 CertiProf · Verify ↗
CSFPC	Cyber Security Foundation Professional 2021 CertiProf · 54846644 ↗
ISO 27001	Information Security Associate 2021 SkillFront · Verify ↗
Cisco IC	Introduction to Cybersecurity 2021 Cisco · Verify ↗
CNSS	Network Security Specialist 2020 ICSI · 17436327 ↗
NSE 1-2	Fortinet Network Security Expert 2020 Fortinet · z0hc8VTQpq / CJrGCGs3dT ↗
Azure	Microsoft Specialist, Azure Infrastructure Solutions 2014 Microsoft · F104-2811 ↗
MCSA	Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate, Office 365 2014 Microsoft · F102-2844 ↗
MCP	Microsoft Certified Professional 2014 Microsoft · F073-9545 ↗
CCNA	Cisco Certified Network Associate 2009 Cisco · CSC011571524

Microsoft MCP transcript ID 11408094